

2.4 Simulators

Simulators are games that focus on accurately recreating a real-life situation in as much detail as possible. Realism is the most important factor here, with every attempt made to make the game as true to real life as the software and hardware can allow. The craze for realism has been taken to incredible levels today, with some games so realistic that they can be used to train professionals in their respective fields! This genre is sub divided into:

a) **Flight Simulators:**

Flight simulators, obviously, try and re-create aircraft and their controls. They attempt to copy the controls found on an aircraft—commercial or otherwise—as well as the difficulty in actually flying one. *Microsoft Flight Simulator* is an excellent example. In fact, it's so realistic that it can even be used to train budding pilots in the operation of those aircrafts!



Microsoft Flight Simulator is the most popular flight simulator today

b) **Racing Simulators:**

Racing simulators are based on accurately re-creating racing environments. This category includes not only car races, but virtually any kind of race, take boating, for instance. The most popular games in this sub-genre are naturally of the car racing variety, with games based on F1 and rallying among the most popular. *Colin McRae Rally 2005*, *MotoGP4* and *Gran Turismo 4* are the best-known titles of this type.